

But high resolution audio gives you the closest thing to what the musicians and sound engineers make in the studio and is the best experience you can have if you pair it with the right devices.

What do you need to listen to high-res music?

Apart from the digital files meeting the specifications we mentioned, the first thing you need on the hardware side to enjoy high res audio is a playback device with a digital-to-analog converter (DAC) that can process these high res files. Since speakers are all analog, most of the audio producing devices around you including your computer, laptop and Blu-ray players come with a DAC pre installed but they are not necessarily good enough. In this case what you can do is install a high quality discrete sound card in your computer or buy a laptop with a good one already installed. You can also use a standalone USB DAC that are compact and powerful enough to give you a rich and vibrant sound experience, and also get you the best out of your digital music. There are a number of good USB DACs available in the market like the Audioquest DragonFly (priced at around ₹18,000) or the Oppo HA-2 (you can get one at around ₹70,000).

If your phone is your primary music device then look for one that comes with a good DAC capable of playing high-res audio. Not all phones in the market can do that, and if you are an audiophile looking for a good phone to fulfil your audio needs, check out the list below

- LG G4 and V10
- Asus Zenfone 3
- Lenovo Vibe K4
- Sony Xperia Z3+ and Z5
- Huawei Nexus 6P
- Motorola Nexus 6
- Marshall London
- HTC 10
- Galaxy S6 and S7
- Iphone 6S and 7

The best bet out of these are the Samsung devices and of course, the Marshall London (every audiophile's dream).

The next important thing is the amplifier being used for playback and the headphone/speaker you pair it with. Even if your DAC does a good job of processing high resolution audio



Audioquest Dragonfly is said to be one of the best inexpensive portable USB DACs available in the market. Plug it in and you are ready to go